

Supplemental Material for: Non-Additive Strain–Doping Coupling in Covalent Molecular Networks: Model Evidence from Quasi-Hexagonal C₆₀

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OVERVIEW

This Supplemental Material accompanies the main Letter on coupled (ϵ, δ) response in qHP C₆₀. All figures and tables are labeled with prefix **S** to match citations in the main text (Fig. S4–S6; Tables S1–S3). Calculations use the same PBE+DFT-D3 CP2K protocol as the main manuscript (rigid biaxial strain unless noted). Observables follow Capobianco *et al.* [1]: π -projected DOS, inverse participation ratio (IPR), nearest-neighbor coupling J , and Marcus reorganization energies $\lambda^\pm$. Converged inputs, outputs, and analysis JSON are archived as described in the main-text Data Availability statement.

COMPUTATIONAL METHODS (FULL PROTOCOL)

All total-energy and electronic-structure calculations use CP2K [2] with PBE [3] and Grimme DFT-D3 (Becke–Johnson damping) [4]. Unless stated otherwise, biaxial strain scales the in-plane lattice vectors of the pristine equilibrium cell at fixed fractional coordinates (rigid-strain protocol), providing an upper bound on strain–doping coupling until ionic-relaxation benchmarks in Table S3 converge. Plane-wave cutoff is 300 Ry for $n \leq 5$ and 280 Ry for $n \geq 6$; $\mathcal{S}(n)$ comparisons at fixed n use identical cutoffs.

Tetramer models ($4 \times \text{C}_{60}$, 240 sites) use B/N/P substitution at nominal 5% (12–13 dopants from archived coordinates, seed 42). Periodic scaling cells contain one dopant per C₆₀ ($n = 1$ –8). Dopant sites are not re-optimized thermodynamically; fixed configurations probe mechanism rather than ensemble averages.

Grids: 24 tetramer strain points ($\epsilon \in \{-5, -2.5, 0, 2.5, 5\}\%$); 12 tetramer electronic points; 40 periodic neutral-energy points at $\epsilon \in \{0, +3\}\%$; charged-state optimizations for Marcus schematics (Fig. S5); IPR/ J factorial (Fig. S6). Linear $\alpha = dE/d\epsilon$ and substitution energies E_f are defined in Table S1.

Non-additive coupling metric. We quantify strain–doping cross terms with the synergy order parameter $\mathcal{S}$:

$$\mathcal{S}(\epsilon, \delta) = \Delta E(\epsilon, \delta) - [\Delta E(\epsilon, 0) + \Delta E(0, \delta)], \quad (\text{S1})$$

where ϵ is biaxial strain, $\delta \in \{B, N, P\}$, and $\Delta E(\epsilon, \delta)$ is the energy per atom relative to the pristine, zero-strain

reference at the same supercell size $n \times \text{C}_{60}$. The bracketed term is the *additive* prediction from separate strain-only and doping-only scans; deviations from zero measure non-additive coupling. Additive superposition gives $\mathcal{S} = 0$; $\mathcal{S} < 0$ indicates cooperative stabilization beyond the two-scan sum, whereas $\mathcal{S} > 0$ indicates cooperative destabilization.

To first order in strain, $\mathcal{S}(\epsilon, \delta) \approx (\alpha_\delta - \alpha_0)\epsilon$ when $\alpha_\delta = dE/d\epsilon$ is evaluated for the doped cell and α_0 for the pristine reference at the same n (rigid-strain protocol); this links the mechanical coefficient α to the cross term at small ϵ .

Periodic-cell $\mathcal{S}$ values are obtained from archived total energies via post-processing of converged CP2K outputs (Supplemental Material Table S2). We report $\mathcal{S}$ for total energy only; an analogous gap cross term $\mathcal{S}_{\text{gap}}$ is not computed here—main-text panel (a) shows that gap slopes need not track $|\mathcal{S}|$.

Localization and coupling (Supplemental Material Fig. S6). Following Capobianco *et al.* [1], we report the inverse participation ratio (IPR) of the charged-state frontier orbital and the nearest-neighbor electronic coupling J from tetramer dimer fragments. IPR follows Supporting Information Eq. (S8), $N \sum_i |\psi_i|^4 / (\sum_i |\psi_i|^2)^2$, on a Mulliken-projected orbital grid; J is estimated from the ground–first-excited splitting of the anionic dimer at fixed interfullerene geometry (two-state model). These observables are computed at the same PBE+D3 level as the energy scans and are *not* directly comparable in absolute value to the Koopmans-compliant $J \simeq 75$ –81 meV reported for pristine qHP networks [1], but they provide an internally consistent trend under coupled (ϵ, δ) .

Polaron binding (Supplemental Material). Marcus reorganization energies follow the vertical–adiabatic decomposition [1]: $\lambda^\pm = E_{\text{vert}}^\pm - E_{\text{opt}}^\pm$, with separate internal ($\lambda_{\text{loc}}^\pm$) and environmental ($\lambda_{\text{env}}^\pm$) contributions when geometry subsets are relaxed. Charged-state relaxations and vertical single-points are documented in Supplemental Material Fig. S5.

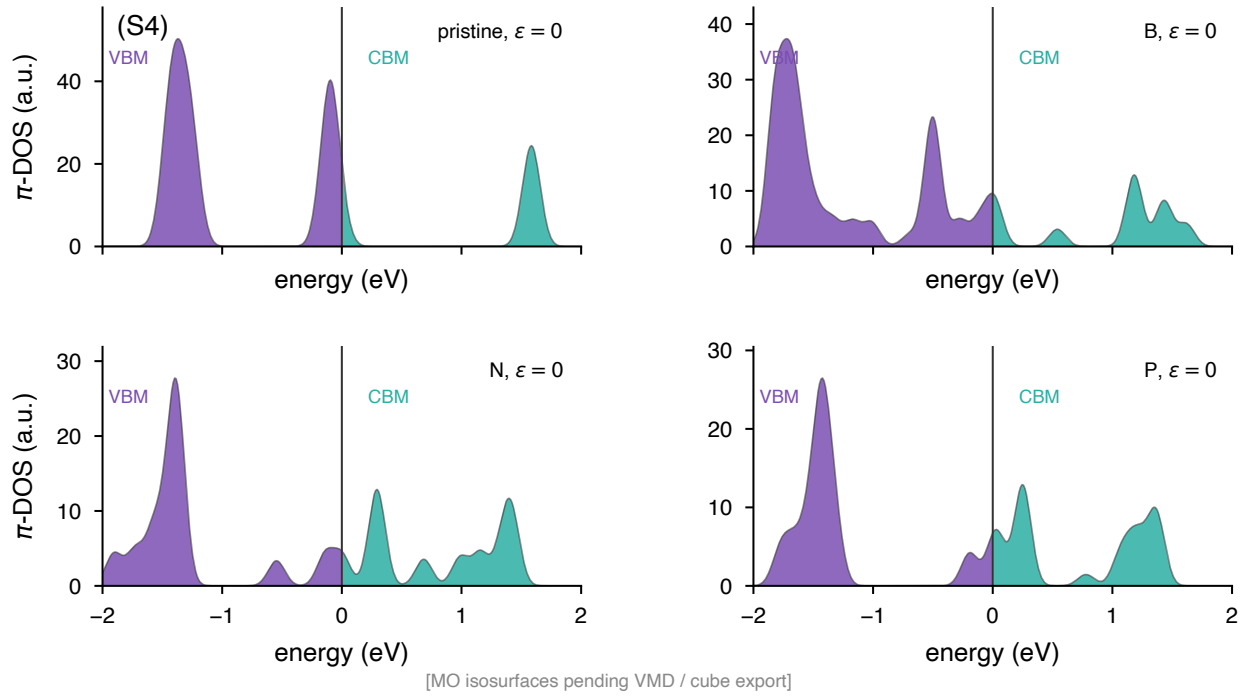


FIG. S1. π -projected density of states (π -DOS) for pristine and B/N/P-doped tetramers at $\epsilon=0$ (PBE+D3). Valence band edges (purple) and conduction band edges (teal) follow the color scheme of Capobianco *et al.* [1]. Energy is relative to the Fermi level at 0 eV. Molecular-orbital isosurfaces are pending cube export.

TABLE S1. Total energies, linear strain sensitivities, and substitution energies for tetramer models (PBE+D3, rigid-strain protocol). $E_f = (E_{\text{doped}} - E_{\text{pristine}})/n_{\text{dopants}}$ at $\epsilon=0$ with no chemical-potential reference (not a standard formation enthalpy). n_{dopants} is counted from archived input coordinates (nominal 5% target; B: 13, N: 12, P: 12).

System	n_{dop}	$E(0\%)$ (Ha)	$E(+5\%)$ (Ha)	α (meV/%)	E_f (eV/dopant)
Pristine	—	−1363.5512	−1363.5509	−1.0	—
B-doped	13	−1328.4900	−1328.4090	+56.9	+73.4
N-doped	12	−1414.3812	−1414.4053	−303.2	−115.3
P-doped	12	−1370.4965	−1370.4888	−19.1	−15.8

TABLE S1

TABLE S2

TABLE S3

FIGURE S4

FIGURE S5

FIGURE S6

- [1] A. Capobianco, A. Breglia, P. Gentile, G. Capano, A. Asinari, G. Drera, L. Sangaletti, M. Cossi, and S. Casassa, Nano Letters **24**, 7891 (2024), polaron localization and mobility in monolayer fullerene networks.
- [2] J. VandeVondele, M. Krack, F. Mohamed, M. Parrinello, T. Chassaing, and J. Hutter, Computer Physics Communications **167**, 103 (2005), cP2K software reference; calculations use CP2K 2025.1.

- [3] J. P. Perdew, K. Burke, and M. Ernzerhof, Physical Review Letters **77**, 3865 (1996), pBE exchange-correlation functional used in all DFT inputs.
- [4] S. Grimme, S. Ehrlich, and L. Goerigk, Journal of Computational Chemistry **32**, 1456 (2011), dFT-D3 with Becke–Johnson damping (VDW potential keyword in CP2K inputs).

TABLE S2. Summary of converged DFT calculations and correspondence to main-text results. The ~ 90 tasks cited in the main text are the converged calculations that directly support quantitative claims; the full archive includes additional preliminary grids (rows marked “not used”).

Calculation set	Model	Converged tasks	Main-text usage	Notes
Early strain probe	$2 \times C_{60}$	5	not used	superseded by tetramer grids
Single-molecule doping	C_{60}	11	not used	superseded
Early electronics	$2 \times C_{60}$	24	not used	superseded by tetramer PDOS
Polaron IPR/ J factorial	tetramer	4	Fig. S6; main inset	pristine/ $B \times \epsilon=0, +3\%$
Tetramer strain energies	tetramer	24	Table S1, α	rigid strain
Optimal-design grid	tetramer	20	not used	archive only
Tetramer PDOS/gaps	tetramer	12	Fig. S4; main panels	
Geometry references	tetramer relax	6	charged-state inputs	reference geometries
Charged polarons	tetramer $q = \pm 1$	partial	Fig. S5	λ pending vertical SP
Size scaling	$n \times C_{60}$	40	main $\mathcal{S}(n)$	280 Ry for $n \geq 6$
$n=6$ cutoff control	$6 \times C_{60}$	pending	N sign benchmark	300 Ry matched run
Ionic relaxation (tetramer)	tetramer	pending	Table S3	fixed-cell GEO_OPT

TABLE S3. Ionic-relaxation benchmark for the tetramer $P@ + 3\%$ synergy corner (four fixed-cell GEO_OPT corners). Main-text $\mathcal{S}(n)$ in panel (d) of the composite figure uses *periodic* $n \times C_{60}$ rigid-strain energies (PBE+D3); this table tests whether a tetramer cross term survives atomic relaxation under the same biaxial cell. Rigid tetramer energies are from the archived tetramer strain-energy grid (PBE, no D3); relaxed energies use PBE+D3 fixed-cell GEO_OPT (300 Ry) as described in the Data Availability statement. $\mathcal{S}$ follows Eq. (S1) with $N=240$ atoms.

Quantity	Rigid (legacy tetramer)	Relaxed (GEO_OPT)
$E(\text{pristine}, \epsilon=0)$ (Ha)	−1363.5512	pending
$E(\text{pristine}, \epsilon=3\%)$ (Ha)	−1363.5522	pending
$E(P, \epsilon=0)$ (Ha)	−1370.4965	pending
$E(P, \epsilon=3\%)$ (Ha)	−1370.4890	pending
$\mathcal{S}$ (meV/atom)	+0.96	pending
Sign vs. periodic $n=4$ $\mathcal{S}_P$ (−23.7 meV/atom)	compare after convergence	

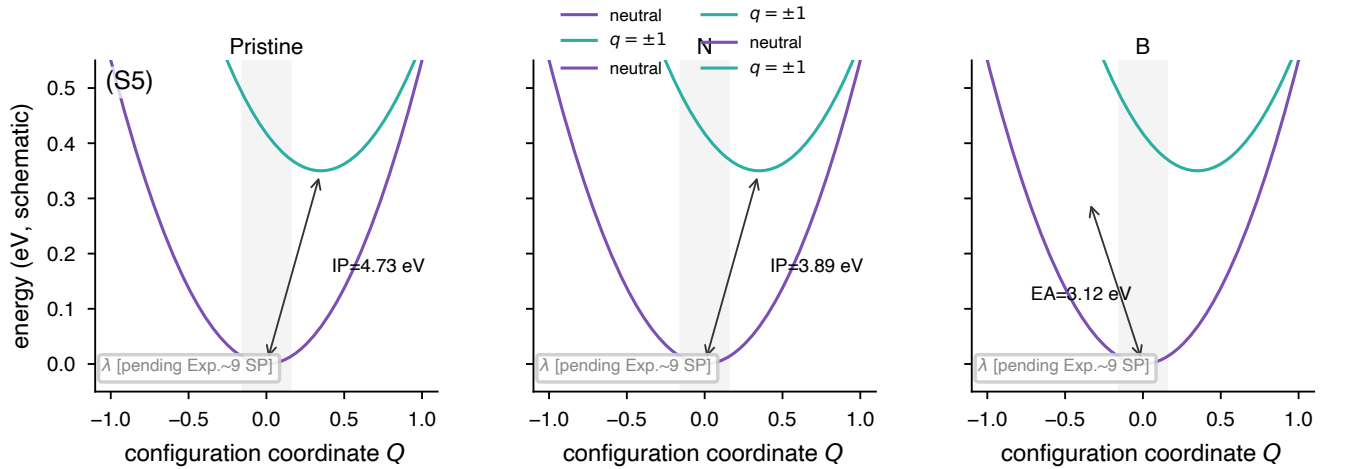


FIG. S2. Schematic configuration-coordinate diagrams for Marcus reorganization energies, following Ref. 1. Panels: pristine (hole, λ^+), N-doped (hole), and B-doped (electron, λ^-). Adiabatic ionization potential (IP) and electron affinity (EA) are from converged charged-state geometry optimizations; $\lambda^\pm = E_{\text{vert}}^\pm - E_{\text{opt}}^\pm$ remains pending vertical single-points at the neutral geometry.

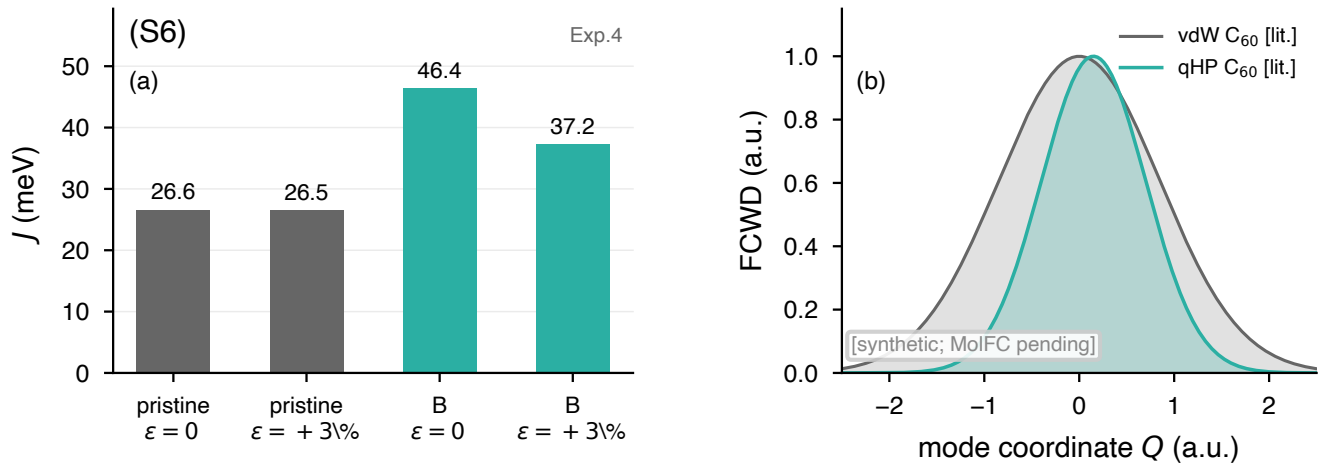


FIG. S3. Transport-adjacent observables (PBE+D3). **(a)** Nearest-neighbor electronic coupling J on the 2×2 factorial (pristine/B $\times \epsilon=0, +3\%$); single-point values without statistical error bars. **(b)** Illustrative Franck–Condon weighted density (FCWD) envelope—a *schematic placeholder* only; tetramer MolFC generating-function calculations are pending and this panel must not be read as a computed spectrum. The horizontal axis is a dimensionless mode coordinate Q .